
Levels of Difficulty for other performing options

Improvisation

Improvisations should be awarded a Level of Difficulty (LoD) according to the outcome: the final recorded performance should be judged against the appropriate set of criteria for the instrument in question.

Realisation

Realisations will normally be standard difficulty level unless the student demonstrates a particularly basic example of the genre (in which case it will be judged as easier) or a particularly involved, complex performance (when it will be judged as more difficult).

Multi-track recording

A. Where the student has performed one or more of the live tracks, the whole performance should have the same LoD as that which would be applied to the part assessed for accuracy.

B. Where the student has not performed any of the live tracks, the recording should always be assessed as standard, unless there is clear evidence that the demands of the task were well beyond the minimum specification requirements (when it will be judged as more difficult).

C. If a recording mixes sequencing and recording, the whole performance will have the same LoD as that which would be applied to the sequencing element.

Rehearsing and directing

Rehearsing and directing performances should be assessed as standard.

Unit 2: Composing Music

Overview

Content overview

Composing music emphasises the creative aspect of music and allows students to appreciate the process of creating music. Students will be introduced to the technical and creative skills required by a composer. Students will be encouraged to explore a range of compositional starting points and investigate a range of techniques for developing and manipulating ideas, and turn them into completed pieces of music.

Students can also explore the skills needed to arrange music for different musical forces.

Assessment overview

In this unit students develop musical ideas in the form of compositions and/or arrangements.

They may choose to submit either:

- **two** compositions, or
- **two** arrangements, or
- **one** composition and **one** arrangement.

Each piece must be based on a different Area of Study.

The overall length of the submission, ie both pieces, should total between two and four minutes.

Group compositions are not acceptable.

Each student submission must comprise:

- **either** a notated score (either handwritten or printed) **or** a written commentary containing sufficient performance directions to allow for a realisation of the piece
- a recording (on CD/MD/MP3).